Verma's assessment, granted continuous Soviet financial and military support, Najibullah could survive 'indefinitely' if only he withstood the Mujahideen onslaught for the next six months.[147] The fact that Soviet capacities were dwindling (even though the Soviet Union's disintegration was not expected at this stage), and so did Najibullah's appeal among the people of Afghanistan (a strategic aspect when assessing any leader's political longevity), went underappreciated. While Verma's assessment proved correct in the short term as Najibullah lasted in power for three more years, Khosla's assessment stood vindicated in the longer term.

Facing policy inertia, and despite the many warning bells, instead of engaging with the Mujahideen, India had decided to continue its relationship with Najibullah. After Khosla, in 1990, India dispatched senior diplomat Hamid Ansari, who later became vice president of India in 2007, as ambassador to Kabul. But due to some disciplinary problems with his number two, Ansari was recalled to New Delhi. In his place, the diplomatic mantle went to Vijay K. Nambiar in October 1990. A 1968-batch foreign service officer (who spoke fluent mandarin), Nambiar had played a critical role in Rajiv Gandhi's momentous visit to Beijing in 1988 (and would later become deputy national security advisor in 2005). India's Afghanistan policy at this juncture was being managed by the foreign secretary, but was being crafted in detail by the relevant joint secretary and the ambassadors (Ronen Sen, a senior diplomat who represented India in Washington from 2004 to 2009, was the joint secretary on the MEA's Pakistan-Afghanistan-Iran desk at that time). PM V. P. Singh, embroiled in domestic political and economic problems, held a perfunctory meeting with Nambiar before dispatching him to Kabul without a clear political direction. In these circumstances, after consulting with Ronen Sen, Nambiar says, his job was to maintain whatever equities that India could have held in a rather complicated situation of the post-Soviet withdrawal in Afghanistan, where 'we [India] did have a fair amount of vested interest in keeping and advancing the support to the Najib regime … [this was so because] we wanted to have influence on the Kabul people to the extent that we could'.[148] It was classic foreign policy conservatism, compounded by domestic political turmoil and Rajiv's overarching influence (despite being out of power) on the MEA's regional political outlook in general